

Community Development Public Hearing December 18th 2024

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=23xvNR6DtKs
Publication Date	2024-12-18T15:47:41Z
Target Category	muncie_city

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

- **Session Type & Topic:** Community Development Block Grant (CDBG) and HOME Investment Partnerships 5-Year Consolidated Plan Public Hearing [00:00:35](#).
- **Summary of Discussion:**
 - Led by Gretchen Cheesman, Director of Community Development, alongside staff members Nikita Adams (CDBG projects) and Melissa Pulin (HOME projects).
 - The hearing was broadcast on Facebook Live for informational purposes only; public comments were required to be submitted via email, regular mail, or delivered directly to the office.
 - The purpose of the hearing was to identify community needs and priorities, educate citizens on eligible activities for CDBG and HOME funds, and solicit public input.
 - **CDBG Funding & Allocation Overview:** CDBG funds are flexible federal monies with specific compliance strings. Proposed allocations include:
 - Administration: 20%
 - Public Services: 15% (limited specifically to agencies serving or addressing the causes of homelessness)
 - Clearance/Demolitions: 30%

- Infrastructure & Homeowner Rehabilitation: 56% (paving, sidewalks, parks, home rehab)
- **HOME Funding Overview:** Allocated as 10% for administration, with the remainder directed toward rental/permanent supportive housing, homeownership (down payment assistance and development via subrecipients like PathStone, Eco Rehab, and Habitat for Humanity), and Community Housing Development Organization (CHDO) operating funds and set-asides.
- **Grant Amounts:** Based on previous year figures (Program Year 2025 runs June 1 to May 31). The 2024 CDBG grant was approximately \$1,276,642, and the 2024 HOME grant was approximately \$359,534 (representing about a 15% decrease from the prior year). Adjustments will be publicly noticed if actual 2025 allocations differ.
- **Public Testimony / Comments:**
 - **Stacey Wheeler (00:07:44), Executive Director of Classroom Connections Indiana (1318 South Madison Street):** Shared that her nonprofit previously received a 2018 CDBG grant of just under \$17,000 for HVAC units, which helped the organization survive COVID-19. She noted plans to apply for public service funding to support staffing for their educational resource distribution warehouse. She also raised serious safety concerns regarding traffic conditions on Madison Street (speeding, wide SUVs, and semi-trucks), noting that teachers have been splashed, donors face dangerous conditions, and a car crashed into their landscaping retaining wall on November 1st, prompting a desire to relocate their main entrance to the 7th Street side.
 - **Unnamed Speaker (00:11:56) [Representing a shelter/homeless services provider]:** Expressed appreciation for ongoing shelter support, noting a concerning increase in young women and young children experiencing homelessness (specifically citing trends near local schools/high schools). They also highlighted difficulties residents face in obtaining vital identification documents to access services, specifically mentioning transportation and BMV access barriers.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

(Note: This transcript captures a statutory public hearing session held by the Community Development Department rather than a formal City Council or Board business meeting. Specific municipal board roll call attendance was not recorded in this segment.)

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

(Not applicable to this public hearing transcript excerpt.)

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

(Not applicable to this public hearing transcript excerpt; no formal ordinances, resolutions, or board votes were conducted during this session.)

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(Public comments were integrated directly into the public hearing proceedings detailed in Section 1 above.)

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Staff noted that future public hearings will be held if funding allocations change prior to finalizing the 2025 action plan.
 - **Adjournment:** The transcript concludes while staff and attendees are actively discussing public transit and BMV access logistics (00:13:18); a formal adjournment time was not captured in the provided text.
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